FOR YOUNG AND GREAT MINDS

WHY HARM YOUR BODY?



DR BARNABAS AND MRS MOYOSOLA ADEFEMI

WHY HARM YOUR BODY?

Take Responsibility
in Addressing Unhealthy Habits
That Negatively Affect Your Health

BY

DR. BARNABAS & MRS MOYOSOLA ADEFEMI

A

MEDICOVANGELISM INITIATIVE

For Young and Great Minds

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FOREWORD

In a world where convenience often trumps consciousness, many of us unknowingly engage in habits that slowly erode our health and well-being. In an age of relentless pace and endless distractions, young people are constantly navigating choices that shape their future—physically, emotionally, and spiritually. ***Why Harm Your Body? Take Responsibility in Addressing Unhealthy Habits That Negatively Affect Your Health*** is a timely and necessary call to action—a bold invitation to pause, reflect, and reclaim ownership of our physical and spiritual well-being.

This literature does not merely catalogue the dangers of poor lifestyle decisions; it challenges readers to confront the deeper question of accountability. It urges us to move beyond passive awareness into active responsibility—because true wellness begins not in the clinic, but in the daily decisions we make about what we eat, how we move, how we rest, and how we cope.

From a medical standpoint, the book offers evidence-based insights into how unhealthy habits compromise our bodies. From a Christian perspective, it reminds us that our bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit (1 Corinthians 6:19-20)—sacred vessels entrusted to us by God. To harm the body is not only a health risk but a spiritual misstep.

Taking responsibility, therefore, becomes both a clinical imperative and a moral duty. Whether you are a student, a policymaker, or simply someone seeking to live more intentionally, this work offers both insight and inspiration. It is a reminder that our bodies are not battlegrounds for neglect, but vessels of purpose, resilience, and healing. Let this be your wake-up call. Let this be your turning point.

Dr. Adesola KAREEM (FWACP)
Specialist in Adolescent and Reproductive Health

PREFACE

"Why harm your body?" is not a question of judgment; it is a cry of concern. In a world saturated with destructive influences, from drug abuse and self-harm to dangerous lifestyles, choices, and neglect, many have come to see pain as normal, reckless lifestyles as acceptable, and damage as deserved. But it doesn't have to be that way.

This work is part of the **BTBH initiative**, (Bring Them Back Home) a movement dedicated to helping young people break free from harmful habits and rediscover their worth in the plan and purpose of God. Through this resource, we aim to shine a gentle light on the value of the body, the hidden reasons behind self-destructive behaviour, and the hope that healing is possible.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

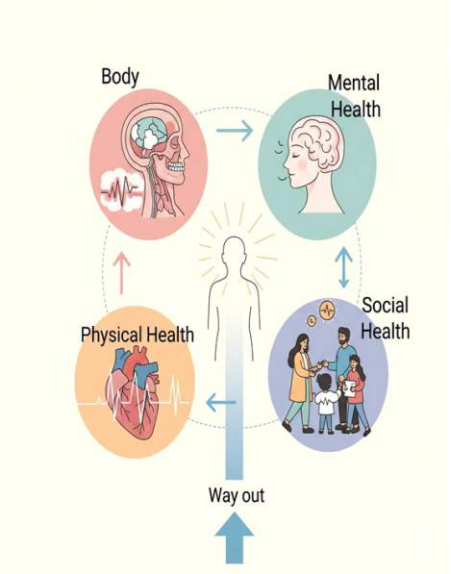
We want to express our sincere gratitude to the almighty God who made it possible for this book to be written, we are forever grateful for this divine initiative through His leading and inspiration.

Also, we appreciate the beautiful effort and unwavering support of Reverend Canon Dimeji and Mrs. Mary Akinlami of the St. Johns Mary secondary school Owo, Ondo State, who made their platforms available for us to reach out to the youths. They also pointed out the need to include health talks in our interactions with them. This further necessitated the writing of this book.

We are deeply grateful to Dr. Adesola Kareem for her insightful foreword, which has helped to frame the core message of this book".
We must also extend our heartfelt gratitude to Dr. Peter Kayode, who thoroughly read our manuscript, and made necessary corrections.

Mr. Joshua Onwochei's immense contribution in the editing of this book is very much appreciated.
Finally, we recognize Mr. Goodness Oni, who designed the beautiful cover page that caught the attention of many and Mr. Olawale Olarewaju who always gives his counsel and support when needed. Your labour of love will always be remembered.

TABLE OF CONTENTS



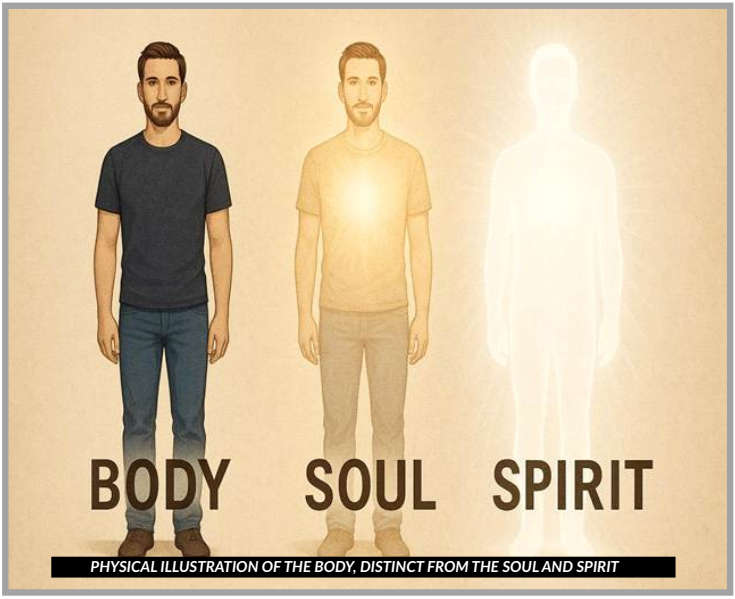
Foreword	**iii**
Preface	**V**
Acknowledgment	**Vi**
The Body	**1**
Mental Health	**3**
Physical Health	**6**
Social Health	**10**
Way Out	**14**
Conclusion	**19**

CHAPTER ONE

THE BODY

The body is more than skin and bones; it is the vessel of your dreams, emotions, talents, soul and spirit. It carries you through every joy, struggle, and every moment of growth. Yet today, countless young people are unknowingly harming the very thing that houses their potentials and purpose.

The body remains the vessel for God to express his redemptive work on earth as seen in the coming of Jesus Christ in the flesh in a bid to save mankind from eternal damnation. Likewise, you need your body to carry out God's purpose here on earth through your spirit and soul's alignment with God. Hence, you and I have an eternal responsibility to cherish and care for our bodies as the temple of God (1 Corinthians 6:19-20).



PHYSICAL ILLUSTRATION OF THE BODY, DISTINCT FROM THE SOUL AND SPIRIT

Looking at the image shown, a man is made up of the spirit, soul, and body. These three have major roles they play to enhance the success of the man as it relates to his existence on earth.

1. The spirit is the invisible being in man responsible for receiving inspiration or guidance from spiritual sources made available, or exposed to it. Such inspiration, either negative or positive, is further passed across to the soul and body.
2. The soul is an invisible being in man, often referred to as the 'inner man'. The information passed from the spirit to the soul goes a long way to determine the functionality of the body.
3. The body is the tangible physical part of a person that interacts with the material world; it is through the body that all the activities of human existence take place. One cannot become what is desired without the functionality of the body. If a particular part of the body ceases to function well, chances are that certain achievements in life may not be possible.

CHAPTER TWO
MENTAL HEALTH



Above is an image of a padlocked brain that has lost its sense of reasoning.

The padlocked brain here shows that the ability to think reasonably and logically has been lost, it has also been disconnected from reality, and this is as a result of the terrible harm done to it. So many factors can be responsible for this, but for the sake of focus and clarity, we will consider depression and drug addiction only.

DEPRESSION

It is a mood disorder that affects the ability to think and act brightly. This is due to circumstances that are assumed to be beyond human control. It defines a state of sadness and loss of interest in various happenings around the environment, and most times may lead to suicidal thoughts. If not well managed, depression may result in varying degrees of sicknesses, and eventually, suicide for some.

Certain mistakes made in life by some, due to unhealthy lifestyle have led them into depression because they feel the damage done can never be corrected. Also, some feel life is so unfair to them due to the many challenges they face, like:

- Maltreatment by people
- Loss of loved ones or properties
- Molestation, and
- Unmet expectations

This set of people, if care is not taken, may end up being depressed

DRUG ADDICTION



The man in the photograph has become so used to substance abuse to the point of affecting his sanity. He can no longer differentiate between right and wrong, judging from his messy environment.

The use of such harmful drugs like cocaine and marijuana, leads to the overproduction of some chemical substances that causes dissociation or separation of the brain from normal and right thinking. A continuous production of these chemicals can lead to irreparable damage to the brain. When the brain is damaged, the body is left with no choice than to act abnormally. Certain psychological (mental and behavioral) problems such as:

- Illogical thinking
- Memory loss
- Insanity
- Stroke

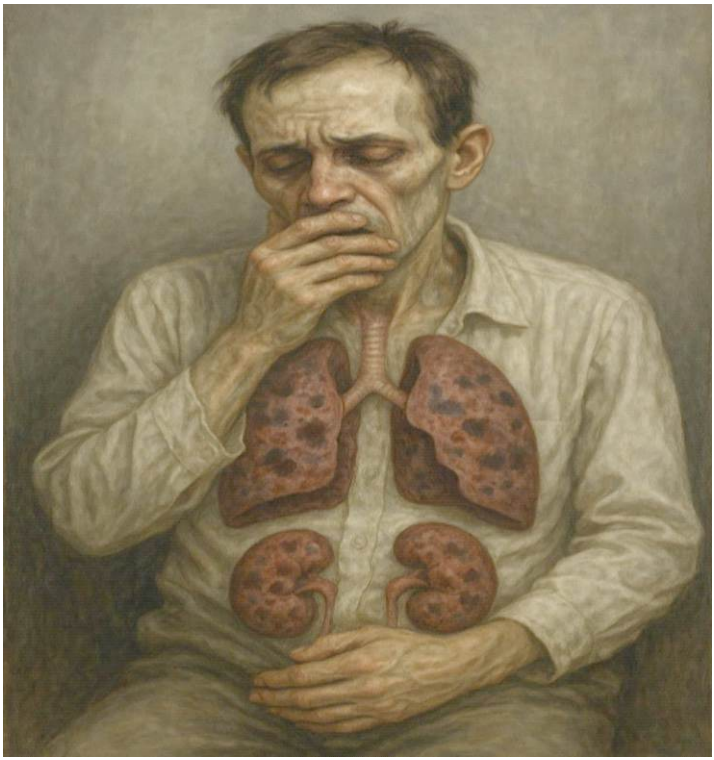
Other physical health issues like, lung or heart disease, and cancer, may begin to set in.

Some factors are responsible for the use of harmful drugs, and one of them is depression.

- For some, taking such harmful drugs when depressed apparently relieves them of overthinking, unknown to them is the numerous harm done to the brain.
- Some take such drugs to get rid of their sense of empathy and sympathy towards others, in order to carry out wicked acts they will not feel sorry for.
- There are also youths who as a result of peer influence, engage in the use of these drugs to feel high (Euphoria), thereby getting addicted.

CHAPTER THREE

PHYSICAL HEALTH



The image above shows the badly affected kidney and lungs of a man who has perhaps, exposed himself to an unhealthy lifestyle. Certain factors are responsible for this, but for brevity, we will consider smoking, taking of alcohol, and bleaching.

Though we have people today who justify their reasons for getting addicted to these things based on their varied beliefs, their justifications do not rule out the danger they may face, if sustained.

SMOKING

It introduces harmful chemicals that irritate and inflame the airways, destroy the air sacs (where oxygen and carbon dioxide are exchanged between the lungs and the blood), weaken or damage the lungs' natural defences which might eventually lead to lung diseases.

ALCOHOL DRINKING

It has been proven to cause different types of cancer, liver, and heart diseases because of the way it is metabolized in the body when consumed. It forms a toxic compound (Acetaldehyde) that can damage the DNA. Even moderate consumption of alcohol is not advised, as it might also have the same effect as those taking it regularly.

BLEACHING OF THE SKIN

As attractive and acceptable it may be for some, bleaching has caused health problems for many due to their ignorance. Majority of these bleaching creams contain a toxic metal (mercury) that can cause kidney damage and other serious health issues. The more the skin is lightened, the more exposed and vulnerable it gets to infections.

UNCLEAN ENVIRONMENT

It is clear from the picture that the family eating care less about the health hazards associated with living in such a dirty environment. Staying in an unclean environment poses serious risk to your health and may eventually lead to terrible health problems if not taken seriously.



1. An environment of this kind breeds mosquitoes, which might eventually lead to malaria.
2. It is also obvious from the above that the source of water is unclean, which by itself can cause cholera
3. The prevalence of Lassa fever in the society today is also connected to the exposure of foodstuffs to such dirty environments, which in turn attracts rats that carry the Lassa virus in them. Once these rodents gain access to the food items, they might get them infected through their urine, saliva, or faeces.

JUNK FOOD

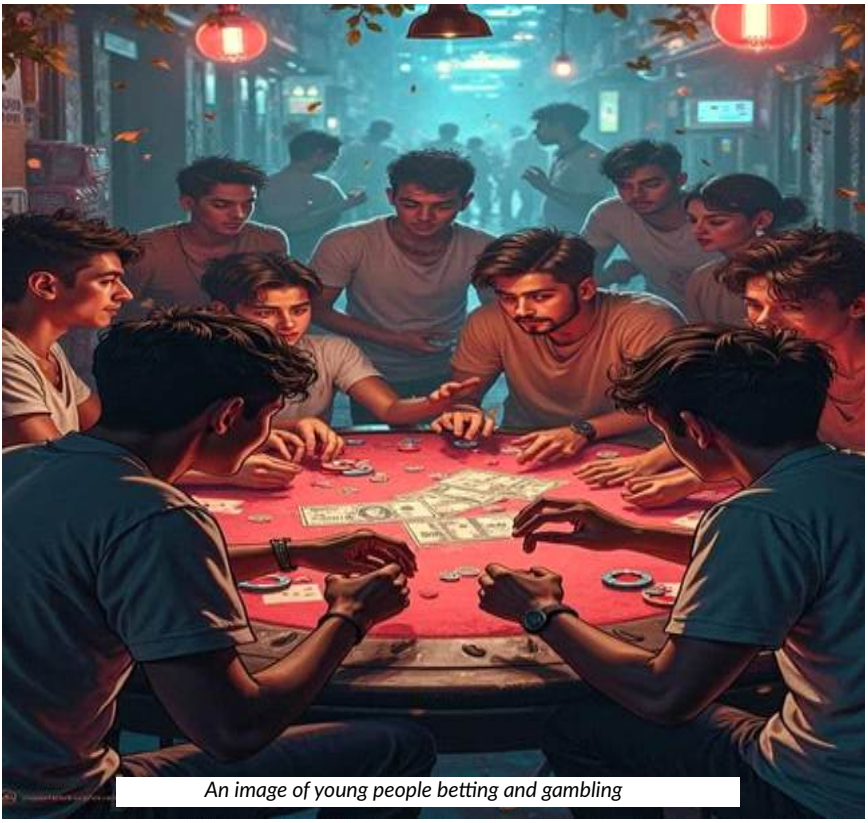
Many today depend on junk food (food with too much fat, sugar, or salt, which also lack certain nutrients) to sustain themselves daily. Examples of such food are; biscuit, doughnut, shawarma, pizza, chips, instant noodles, puff-puff, akara, etc.

Some of these foods are gotten from restaurants or personally prepared. Eating junk foods can lead to short and long term health problems such as diarrhea, diabetes, obesity, and numerous heart issues.



CHAPTER FOUR

SOCIAL HEALTH



An image of young people betting and gambling

BETTING AND GAMBLING

One of the indicators that show that our society is being threatened today is the fast rise of negative social interactions among the youths. This can be linked to so many factors, ranging from:

- Improper parental upbringing
- Unchecked temperament and appetites, leading to bad moral values

- Social media influence
- Poverty and many more.

Your relationship with others impacts greatly on your social well-being. For instance, when your close friends are those who are addicted to betting and gambling, you will be compelled to join them, which in turn increases your crave and desire to acquire more money even if it means that you steal, lie, or cheat to get it. This will further affect you and your loved ones mentally, physically, and socially. If the money invested in gambling was gotten through dubious means and does not multiply as expected, you will be brought under a state of ridicule and shame in the society, and your loved ones will not be left out in the disgrace.

INTERNET FRAUD

Some groups of youths who are into yahoo or yahoo plus, specialize in defrauding innocent people of their money and wealth through deception and diabolical means. This set of youths are fully aware of the pain they subject their victims to, but due to their evil craving for wealth, they do not mind if their victims die or fall into lifelong problems. They also stand the risk of exposing themselves to harmful substances (drugs), charms, or rituals to sustain the pattern of their unlawful behavior; unknown to them is the danger they bring upon their health and sanity.

SEXUAL RELATIONSHIP

Another factor that affects social health negatively is the unhealthy and immoral relationship (boyfriend/girlfriend syndrome) seen among some youths.

- This set of people are deceived into thinking what they should give attention and priority to is an emotional attachment to the opposite gender so as not to lose the joyful experience of their youthful age.
- Many are deluded by the lies about certain dangers of not being sexually active at an early age.
- Some, in the course of looking for human acceptance and love, get themselves entangled.
- Others fall prey seeking financial assistance.

As reasonable as these justifications may be to them, it is worthy of note that these assertions are not true, and failure to realize this on time will lead to unexpected harm and danger. These people stand a risk of getting infected with various kinds of diseases like:

- HIV and AIDS
- Vagina and mouth infection
- Syphilis
- Gonorrhea
- Hepatitis B

The medium through which these diseases are contacted is either through the saliva, sweat, blood, or sexual intercourse.

For the female gender, some end up getting pregnant, bringing shame and ridicule to themselves and their families, while others ignorantly opt for abortion, which might further endanger their lives at that moment or in the future.

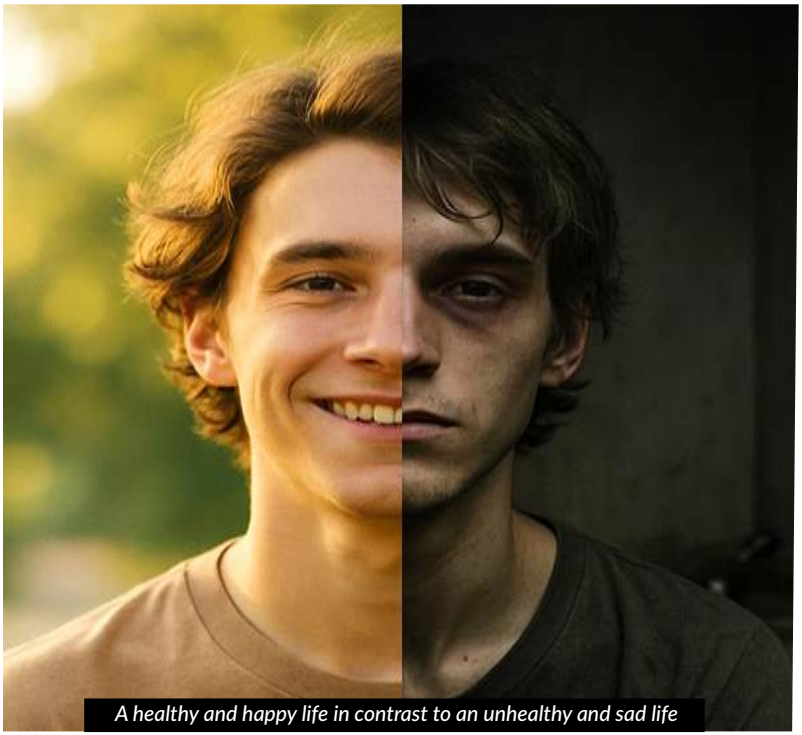
HARMFUL CLUSTERS

Finally, cultism, armed robbery, gangsterism and kidnaping are other vices wasting the precious lives of several youths and

that of innocent people in the society. They are being deceived into joining these wicked groups due to certain so-called benefits they perceive to be associated with them. They are oblivious of the depth of wickedness they engage in at all times. Many end up in police cells or prison, psychiatric homes, endangering the lives of their family and friends by exposing them to the harm of deadly cult groups. Others get infected with various kinds of diseases due to risky exposures, and some even die in the process.

CHAPTER FIVE

THE WAY OUT



A healthy and happy life in contrast to an unhealthy and sad life

You must understand that your body is a very important aspect of your existence on earth, and how you make use of it will largely determine your productivity and safety.

You must be able to discern between what is right from what is wrong through godly inspiration and counsel, this will help you to progressively actualize your dreams, and influence your society with good moral values.

MENTAL HEALTH

DEPRESSION

Many factors lead youths into depression as stated earlier in this book, and it is not disconnected from the activities of the wicked one(the devil). He ensures that people magnify their problems through their thoughts until they feel frustrated about life. He stirs up problems in the lives of people either through their carelessness, or circumstances, in order to make them slaves to their predicament.

Your only way to overcome the attempt of the wicked one is to make friends with God through His son Jesus Christ. This will keep you ahead of the enemy's attack and grant you peace whenever a distressing situation comes your way.

As earlier stated, some of the reasons why people go into depression are self-induced, for instance;

1. Taking wrong steps in life that eventually became a mess due to lack of proper accountability and principles that guide the affairs of their lives. In case you are about to take any decision or step that might cost you your peace and future, think again so that you won't have yourself to blame in the long run.
2. Some youths go into depression because they are unable to meet life's expectations. They compare themselves with their peers, and eventually consider themselves woeful failures. You cannot become a failure in life because you are unable to live up to expectations. Certain lessons are learnt as people weather through the storms, which cannot be learnt when everything in life comes easily. These help people to become more determined, disciplined, humble,

dedicated, confident, and goal oriented.

3. Also, your ability to depend on God through prayer and the knowledge of the scripture will further activate your faith unto victory over impossible situations.
4. Have positive-minded people around you who you can share your burdens with, and never nurse the thought that no one loves you. We do love you, and that is why this book is specially written for you. God loves you too, and He will always send genuine and sincere people your way who will extend His love towards you until you come out of your problems.

SMOKING, DRUG ADDICTION, AND ALCOHOL DRINKING

Youths who are addicted to these vices constitute a major menace in the society as they appear to be unlawful and unruly in their actions. To break free from such addictions:

1. You must distance yourself from friends or companies that lure you into these vices.
2. No matter how difficult it may seem to break free, you must deliberately stop taking those substances, and also withdraw from patronizing the sellers. Understand that every step taken towards freedom is for your good and future progress.
3. Finally, you must depend on God to overcome your peculiar weakness, and be encouraged to take up new tasks and learn new things that will enhance your productivity and help you actualize your future goals.

PHYSICAL HEALTH

As a young person, one thing you must do to ensure good physical well-being is to prioritize your health above everything else.

1. Your physical environment should be clean and habitable.
2. The water and food you take must be secured from all forms of contamination.
3. Ensure to use a mosquito net while sleeping, to prevent mosquito bites and possible malaria.
4. Take fruits and vegetables regularly to boost your immune system.
5. Drink plenty of water to stay hydrated.
6. Wash your hand frequently with soap and water.
7. Take your bath and brush your teeth regularly to avoid tooth decay and body odour.
8. You are what you eat, so watch what you eat and do not make a habit of taking junk or unhealthy foods that may damage your immune system. Understand your body and what it can accommodate. Neither over feed nor underfeed it, but be moderate with your feeding.

SOCIAL HEALTH

We do not seem to have an ideal society today because people's perceptions of life have been influenced by negative ideologies and opinions.

- You must choose to be different by carefully selecting your motivators, friends, and influencers.
- To avoid the negative influence that brings about wrong values and morals, you will sometimes have to stand alone to uphold worthy values that will help impact your immediate environment and beyond.

- You do not have to lie, cheat, steal, gamble, or kill to become successful in life.
- You do not have to bring fear, tears, and panic before you can become relevant in life.
- You should not be the reason why people are scared to live in their houses and communities.
- Do not entertain the believe that you have greater rights above every other person you come in contact with, it makes you normalize oppressing or looking down on them. Strive to be a source of hope and encouragement instead.
- The journey to success is a gradual but sure process, and you must be ready to abide by the right rules and principles even when you are not financially stable.
- Financial instability should not be a reason for you to join the killer squad or the association of prostitutes. God allows such a situation to enable you to become hard working, depend more on His wisdom and not only on your human abilities.
- An intimate relationship that leads to romance and sex with the opposite gender is supposed to be within the confine of marriage, and not as a youth who is still surviving under his/her parent or guardian, or perhaps alone with no marriage in view. Such an immoral relationship will further plunge you into a state of mental stress, unprepared responsibilities, and unnecessary commitments.

CONCLUSION

Your future goals and aspirations might eventually come to a halt if you keep making yourself vulnerable to your perceived weaknesses. Know that you will only increase the number of wicked persons in the society if you yield to an ungodly and careless lifestyle.

Remember your body and mind are precious assets that deserve care and respect. Any damage done to it may be difficult to undo. You need your brain to think positively and intelligently. Also, you need your internal organs to function efficiently.

Always seek help from trusted and godly adults, professionals, or support groups when you know you are gradually losing control of yourself. You are the next to emerge in an outstanding way. Keep going forward and never give up!

THE WAY OUT

Please Accept the Offer of Jesus Today!



Here is the Love of God:

For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life. **John 3:16.(KJV)**

Come to Jesus

Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls: For my yoke is easy and my burden is light." **Matt 11: 2-30 (KJV)**

2025 PRESIDENTS HONORS AWARD RECEIVED BY DR BARNABAS LOVE ADEFEMI



Dr and Mrs Adefemi with Dr Onuh Sunday Omale, the founder and MD of Deda Hospital Abuja



Dr Barnabas Love Adefemi with his award at the presidential Villa



Dr and Mrs Adefemi



Dr Adefemi is seen shaking one of the dignitaries after receiving the presidential award



NYSC awardees taking a photograph with the DG of NYSC, and the minister for youths and sports development



ABOUT THE AUTHORS

Dr Barnabas and Mrs Moyosola Adefemi are Co founders of the Bring Them Back Home Initiative, (BTBH). An initiative that provides mentorship opportunities for youths to build social, spiritual, academic and life competencies. The initiative' helps youths find clarity towards their identity and develop resilience style of living against societal pressure, in the bid to fulfill their God given purposes. This inadvertently positions them and set them apart to become Godly ambassadors that could positively influence their generation.

Dr Barnabas Adefemi is a Resident doctor at the Federal Medical Center Owo, Ondo State. He is a graduate of Medicine and Surgery from the University of Abuja, Nigeria. During his school days, he got the prestigious Agbami scholarship award, due to his outstanding performance academically. He is also a recipient of the Presidents' Honours Award given by the President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, to outstanding National Youth Corps members that served at their places of duty and also executed impactful community development projects. He has since been passionate about nation building and community development, especially providing leadership and guidance to young minds to enable them walk in the knowledge and fear of God, and to fulfill their God given purposes. Dr Barnabas Adefemi also provides an outstanding leadership to his family supporting them to grow in every ramifications.

Mrs Moyosola Adefemi is a Christian writer, a model mother behind the family visions and goals. She has maintained the quality of been exceptional, thoughtful and God fearing right from her university days, after an undeniable encounter with Jesus changed her life forever. She is a graduate of history from the University of Abuja, Nigeria, and led her class as the best graduating female student. Shortly after her Youth Service, she got married to Dr Barnabas Adefemi. She has since been a pillar that supported the different levels of achievements the family has recorded. She has been a great caregiver to her children and a submissive wife to her husband while they journey through the life of purpose together.
Today, they both work with the Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Innovations (CEPI), and co labour for God in the various visions the Lord has given them.



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- CHOOSE FREEDOM
- CHOOSE HEALTH

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